



shows and channels dedicated to eSports. Pro players and casters are akin to celebrities now. Streaming video game content is free as opposed to other content where you're charged if you want to view stuff. Nintendo attempted to introduce a revenue sharing program with YouTube, wherein they would receive a share of the proceeds. Understandably not everyone was happy about it and it was met with quite



a lot of backlash, but if big shots like EA and Ubisoft decide that you need to pay to watch their content, there's not much we'll be able to do about it.

Thanks to crowdfunding and streaming, indie developers have been able to reach out to a much larger audience. Because of this, indie games have evolved to become much more main-



CLASSIC REVIVAL



With gaming now becoming a worldwide phenomenon, and games like Pokémon GO being the only thing on everyone's mind, one should take a few steps back and just take a look at the way the world has changed in these past few years. You would have to be blind not to notice how "nerd" or "geek" culture – as some call it – has thrived and grown into prominence. What people considered nerdy and geeky back then, like the kind of things that people did hidden away in their basements – we're talking about board games like the classic D&D (dungeons and dragons) or collectible card games, you dirty-minded heathens – are now considered hip and chic. Things that were frowned upon back then, such as following cartoons like Pokémon, or any anime for that matter, is now commonplace throughout the world. It's not like these things weren't being done before, they were, but in secret. Nobody could brag about how many cards they had, or how many figurines they had, or the downscaled Lego city in their basement to just anyone. But now they can, the world has not only accepted them, but has adopted their culture as well. It's a classic "if you can't beat em, join em" situation. And we welcome them happily, the more the merrier.

This reemergence of the old ways or the classics isn't limited to just the indoor classics – again, board games like Ludo or Scrabble, jeez – it's a trend that's becoming popular in the world of gaming as well. The number of classic style and retro games have been increasing as of late. And thanks to sites like Kickstarter and Indiegogo, more of them are being funded and greenlit. Looks like the people want them too. 8-bit games are making a comeback, be it classic platformer style games like Shovel Knight, or top-down shoot-em-up action games like Hotline Miami. The Nintendo Entertainment System, more popularly known as the NES, is also making a comeback, and it looks like it's getting way more attention than both the PlayStation Neo and the Xbox One S. Classic isometric style RPGs like Divinity: Original Sin and Shadowrun Returns are all craze. The world is beginning to appreciate the classics. More and more people are picking up older classics and they're finally getting the appreciation they deserve. Many classics are being ported onto more current devices, so you can now play them on your phones and pads. Perhaps it was time for gaming to return to its roots, where the path leads now, only time will tell.

stream and are able to provide great, quality content. One just needs to take a look at the number of successful indie titles in Steam's library to see what we mean. Take No Man's Sky for example, it is one of the most awaited titles of 2016 and it's an indie title. An ambitious project started by a then team of just 4, but despite all odds it has taken the spotlight, beating out on several AAA titles. This is great for us gamers who are getting more great games to play, at the

same time it's great for the indie game devs and studios as well, who are getting some much deserved credit for their hard work.

All of these factors, both the big and the small, and the ones that have slowly taken form over time and the ones that happened in one fell swoop, they all point to one thing. There are some big changes coming to the world of gaming, and whether you like it or not, you better be prepared. *